

obtained were perfect copies. Another useful feature is support for making software RAID's or virtual volumes. Virtual volumes are a feature found only in NT-based systems, by which partitions can be spread across separate physical disks without the need of separate hardware controllers.

In our scanning speed test, R-Studio was the slowest, taking 50.2 seconds to scan through our test folder. This unusually long scanning time can be very tiresome for those with large disk partitions. To circumvent this, a raw region spanning several partitions can be selected directly from the hard disk for recovery without affecting the data on the disk. This effectively shortens the time required for scanning through the drive. However, this mode is meant for service technicians and hard drive experts only, as the fields for the raw region to be selected have to be filled in according to the disk's geometry. A more detailed explanation in the manual would have been helpful. The manual itself needs a little more depth, as it only covers the basics, assuming that the user has prior knowledge about data recovery.

Later, in our second test, R-Studio actually lost one document, whereas the other two had recovered all files, at least in a partial state. Also, in the next test, while R-Studio did recover the deleted partition satisfactorily, it could not restore the original directory and file structure in the recovered output.

Finally, R-Studio is a tool more suitably targeted for professionals, rather than home users, as it offers a few extra utilities which otherwise would cost more to procure.

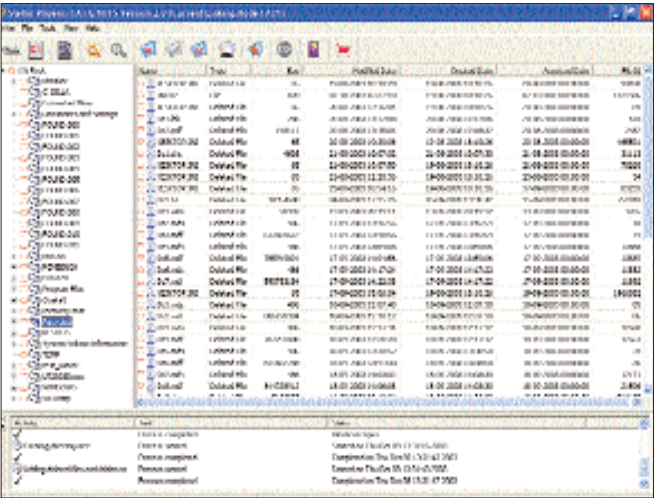
- + Feature-rich, in-built restoration capability
- Cryptic interface that needs slightly more technical expertise

Auto Backup 2.2				
Performance	4	4	4	4
Features	4	4	4	4
Ease of use	4	4	4	4
Overall	4	4	4	4

Stellar Phoenix FAT & NTFS

Not so stellar

Stellar Phoenix is a data recovery tool from Stellar Information Systems Ltd, an ISO 9002-rated Indian company specialising in hard disk recovery utilities. It had the smallest



Click on 'Recover' to start the recovery process in Stellar Phoenix

How do They Do it?

Whenever you delete a file, it's never completely erased from the hard disk—the file's entry is merely removed from the File Allocation Table (FAT). The FAT contains the name and location of each and every file on the hard disk, and this table is checked by the OS every time it boots. So, even after the OS deletes the file's name and location from the FAT, the file is still present on the hard disk in raw form. At this point, if the user realises his error immediately and wants to recover the data, the chances of recovery are very good. This is because recovery software generally don't rely upon the FAT—they, instead, scan the disk for its raw data content. As time passes, the odds of recovering data get slimmer. Also, if you try to recover an old file after adding some new data, the file may not be recoverable at all, as the newer files may have been written into the space once occupied by the older one.

Answers to quiz from page no. 122:

Crossword:

Down:

11 Cell
7 IA64, 8 Celeron,
6 Morgan Core,
3 Transmeta,
2 PowerPC,
1 Hyperthreading.

Across:

4 PentiumM,
5 ExtremeEdition,
10 Cache,
12 Opteron,
7 IA64, 8 Celeron,
11 Cell

Answer:

1 a, 2 b, 3 c, 4 a, 5 c,
6 a, 7 d, 8 d, 9 c,
10 b, 11a, 12 a, 13 a,
14 a, 15 c

1/4th AD